

PROCESSING: PROGRAMMING FOR THE MEDIA ARTS

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HOW **PROCESSING** MADE PROGRAMMING MORE ACCESSIBLE TO ARTISTS AND DESIGNERS

presented By Madjda Fares

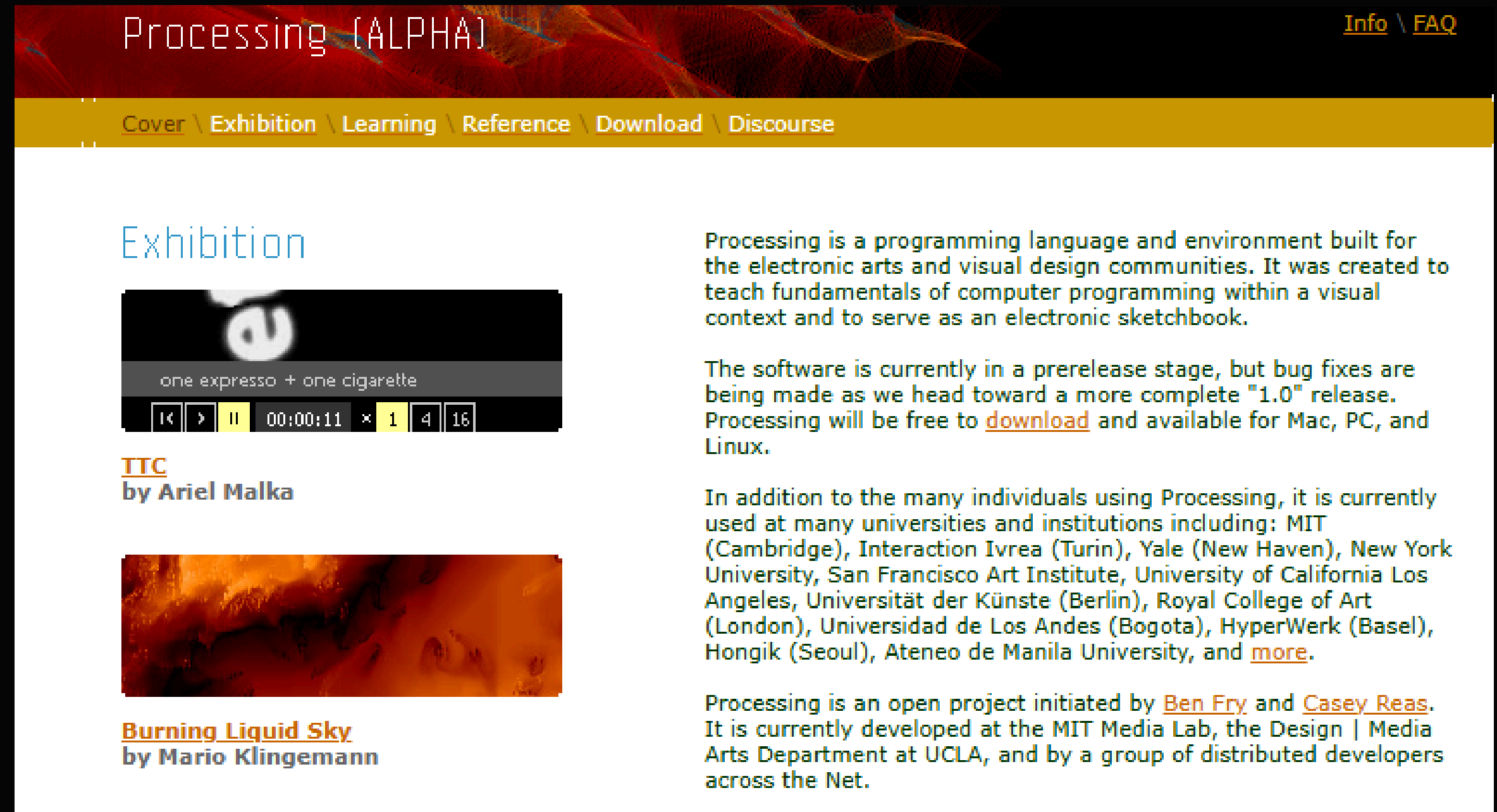
HISTORICAL CONTEXT: CREATIVE CODING BEFORE PROCESSING

- SOFTWARE WAS BECOMING EVERYDAY CULTURE
- CREATIVE WORK DEPENDED ON DIGITAL TOOLS
- MOST TOOLS WERE COMMERCIAL AND CLOSED
- PROGRAMMING WAS STILL A SPECIALIST SKILL



WHAT IS PROCESSING?

- A VISUAL WAY TO LEARN PROGRAMMING
- A SKETCHBOOK FOR TESTING ARTISTIC IDEAS QUICKLY
- A SERIOUS TOOL FOR MAKING INTERACTIVE MEDIA



March, 2004 – Processing
WebArchive

HOW THE AUTHORS VIEW SOFTWARE

- **Software is a unique medium with unique qualities**
 - Can create behavior, motion, interaction, and simulation
- **Each programming language is a distinct material**
 - Each language enables some forms of expression and limits others
- **Sketching is necessary for the development of ideas**
 - Artists need to experiment quickly in code, not only in final polished tools
- **Programming is not just for engineers**
 - Programming can also fit visual and spatial ways of thinking

SOFTWARE LITERACY

- ARTISTS WERE SURROUNDED BY SOFTWARE, BUT RARELY BUILT IT
- LITERACY MEANS SHAPING THE MEDIUM, NOT JUST USING IT
- PROCESSING TRIES TO MAKE THAT FIRST STEP LESS INTIMIDATING

“TO USE A TOOL ON A COMPUTER, YOU NEED DO LITTLE MORE THAN POINT AND CLICK;
TO CREATE A TOOL, YOU MUST UNDERSTAND THE ARCANE ART OF COMPUTER PROGRAMMING.”

–John Maeda–

YOU MUST HAVE BOTH TO BE LITERATE.

–Alan Kay–

OPEN SOURCE AND SHARED PRACTICE

- CREATIVE SOFTWARE WAS MOSTLY CONTROLLED BY BIG COMPANIES
- PROCESSING OPENED THE TOOL INSTEAD OF LOCKING IT DOWN
- CODE SHARING TURNED INDIVIDUAL WORK INTO COLLECTIVE GROWTH



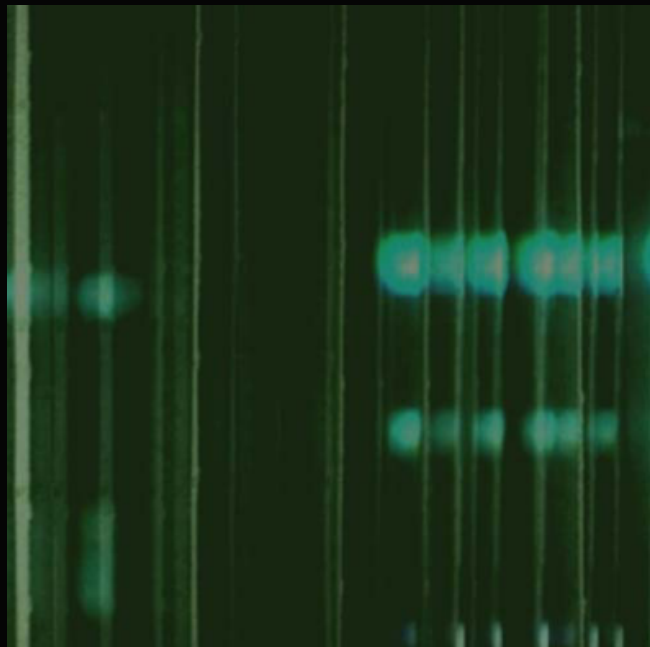
Computer vision motion tracking
Robert Hodgkin



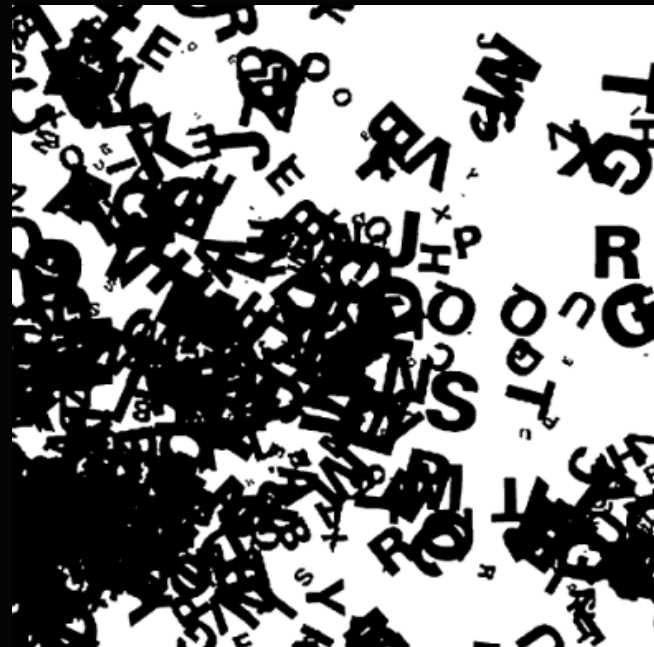
Talking Colors
Laura Hernandez Andrade

EDUCATION

PROCESSING WAS TAUGHT
THROUGH PRACTICE, FROM
SHORT WORKSHOPS TO
INTERACTIVE CLASS PROJECTS.



Lee Soo-jeong



Kim Tai-kyung



Mr Zephyr flight simulation
Leon Hong



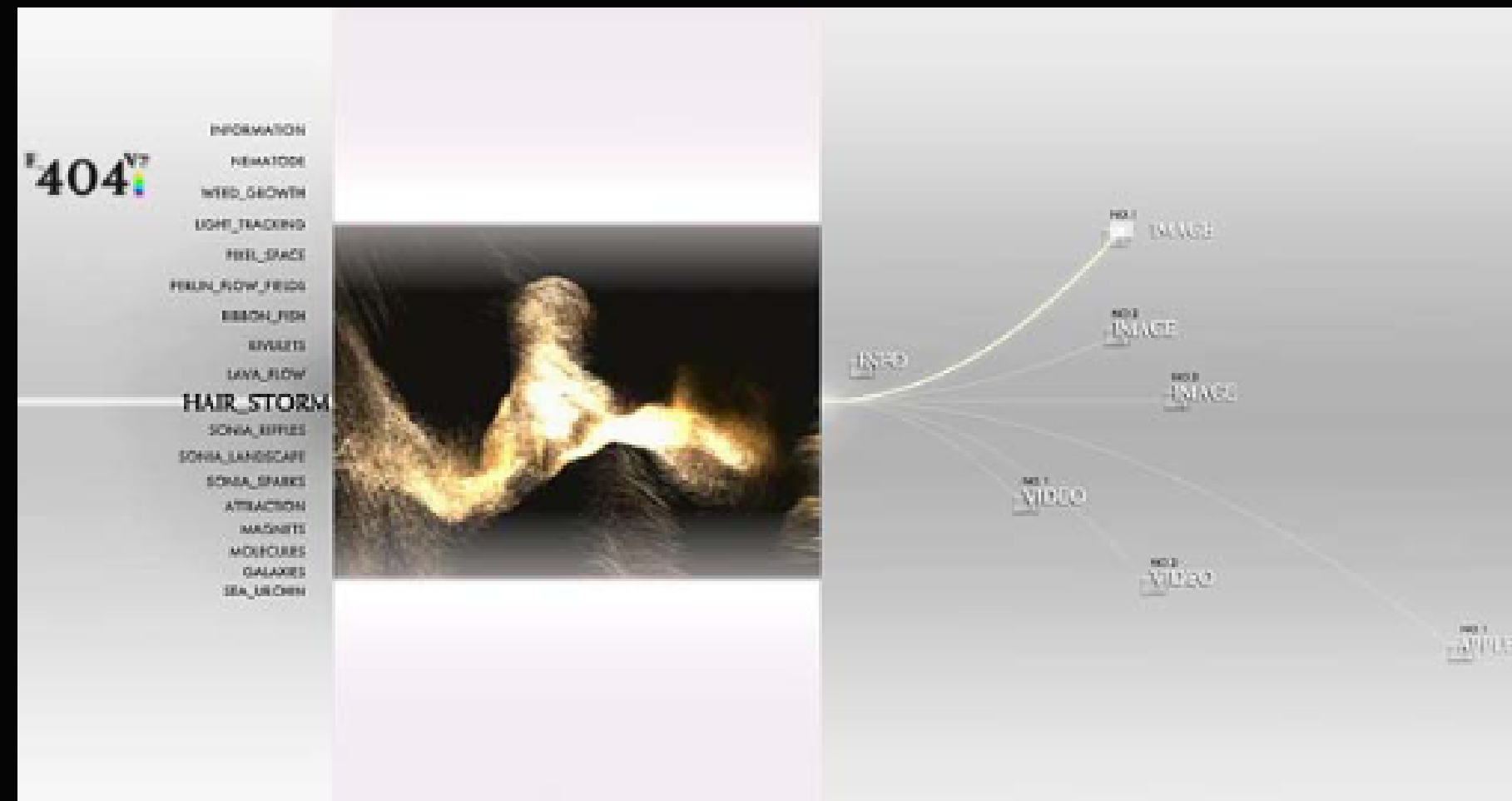
Muskan Srivastava



White Noise – Zai Chang

NETWORKED CIRCULATION

SHARING CODE TURNED INDIVIDUAL EXPERIMENTS INTO
A GLOBAL CREATIVE COMMUNITY.



WHAT PROCESSING BROUGHT TO CREATIVE CODING

- PROCESSING GAVE ARTISTS PERMISSION TO CODE
- IT MADE EXPERIMENTATION FASTER, MORE VISUAL, AND LESS INTIMIDATING
- IT HELPED TURN CREATIVE CODING INTO A SHARED CULTURE, NOT A SOLO TECHNICAL SKILL

**THANK
YOU.**

Questions?